Lehan Zhang

lehan.zhang@hotmail.com | lehan.zhang@gess.ethz.ch | www.lehanzhang.com | Google Scholar

Education

ETH Zürich, Switzerland Aug. 2024 - present
PhD in Economics and Data Science

- Chair of Law, Data Science, and Economics (Ash Group) at the AI & Economics Lab, D-GESS
- Advisor: Prof. Elliott Ash, Secondary Advisor: Prof. Karsten Donnay (UZH)
- Coursework and Summer Schools: Swiss Program for Beginning Doctoral Students in Economics (Study Center Gerzensee), AI & Economics Summer Institute (Chicago Booth), Zurich Summer School in AI & Applied Economics (ETHZ), Language Models for Law and Social Science (Elliott Ash, ETHZ), Causal Inference (Alberto Abadie, Gerzensee Advanced Courses in Economics), Labor Economics (David Dorn, UZH), Social Norms and Development (Eliana La Ferrara, Gerzensee Advanced Courses in Economics), Economic History: Migration, Networks, Religion (Sascha Becker, ISEG Summer School)

University of New South Wales (UNSW), Australia Feb. 2022 - Apr. 2023
B. Economics (Honours) (Econometrics) | First Class Honours

- Recipient of the Gail Kelly Honours Award for Business, a $20,000 AUD scholarship awarded on the basis of all-round academic achievement and leadership
- Advisors: Prof. Gabriele Gratton and Prof. Pauline Grosjean

University of New South Wales (UNSW), Australia Feb. 2018 - Dec. 2021
B. Data Science and Decisions (Quantitative Data Science) | with Distinction

Research

Research Interests: *culture and identity, media, political economics*
Methods: *causal inference, unstructured data, NLP/AI*

Adding Fuel to the (Gun)Fire: How Politicians Polarize the Public Debate *CEPR Discussion Paper* 2026

(with Gabriele Gratton, Pauline Grosjean, and Hasin Yousaf)

The Joe Rogan Effect: Politicized Podcasts and the Youth Gender Voting Gap *Working Paper* 2026

(with Elliott Ash, Sergio Galletta, and Federico Masera)

Socioeconomic Paths into Misogynistic Online Cultures: Evidence from Reddit

(with Elliott Ash and Alexander Hoyle)

Conferences and Seminar Presentations

- 2026: Natural Language in Economics seminar (March, Online), COMPTEXT (April, Birmingham), Workshop IdEP in Sustainable Economics (May, USI), Economics of Media Bias Workshop (May, Hertie School), Center for Law and Economics Brown Bag Seminar Series (May, ETHZ), CESifo Workshop on Digital Platforms (June, Warwick), 4th CEPR Workshop on Media, Technology, Politics, and Society (June, EIEF *coauthor presentation*), Women in Political Economics Workshop (September, WU Vienna), Zurich Political Economy Seminar Series (October, ETHZ/UZH), Digital Publics Conference (October, DSI UZH), OB Research Seminar (November, HEC Lausanne *invited talk*)
- 2025: TILEC Workshop on Economic Governance of Social Media (Tilburg University), 3rd CEPR Workshop on Media, Technology, Politics, and Society (Bocconi University), Applied Young Economists Workshop on Political Economics (Online), Zurich Political Economy Seminar Series, Meditation Chan & Future World Conference (Shaolin Temple)
- 2024: Center for Law and Economics Brown Bag Seminar Series (ETHZ), 2nd Resilient Democracy Lab Workshop (UNSW)
- 2023: Econometric Society Australasia Meeting (UNSW)

Teaching and professional activities

Teaching Assistant at ETH Zurich

- Methods IV: Statistical Learning (2025)

Teaching Assistant at University of New South Wales

- ECON5306/3106: Politics and Economics (tutor-in-charge, 2022, 2023, 2024)
- ECON2111: Developmental Economics (2022, 2023)
- ECON3124: Behavioural Economics (2022)
- ECON1401: Economic Perspectives (2022, 2023)
- ECON1202: Quantitative Analysis for Economics (2023)
- COMM5000: Data Literacy for Business (2023)

Organizer of Symposium in AI+Mindfulness 2025

Work Experience

UNSW Resilient Democracy Lab Apr. 2023 - Aug. 2024

Research Fellow, *full-time*

- Conducting independent economics research and joint research with senior Lab fellows for publication
- Prepare replication reports for Institute for Replication (I4R) meta-analysis on terrorism and politics papers
- Administrative tasks including maintaining the Lab website and organizing research workshops

UNSW School of Economics Oct. 2020 - Apr. 2024

Research Assistant

- Undergraduate Research Fellow of the UNSW Resilient Democracy Lab: building the lab website and summarizing research for showcase on the website
- RA work for Prof. Pauline Grosjean on data visualization, textual analysis, and data cleaning for various projects, including *Grosjean, Masera, and Yousaf (2023), QJE* and *Patriarcapitalisme* (2021)
- RA work for A.Prof. Jane Zhang: writing ethics applications, conducting literature review, co-designing an experiment on mental health and technology, building the experimental treatment mobile application and Qualtrics survey, managing logistics of pilot implementation

Lehan Zhang Photography Jan. 2017 - Present

Freelance Photographer, Photojournalist | *View portfolio here*

- Provide reportage photography services to private and corporate clients including MigrArt, 4A Centre for Contemporary Asian Art, Belvoir Street Theatre, UNSW Sydney, Gonski Institute, OutInCanberra, Region Canberra
- Managing editor of Australian and Swiss music and entertainment media publication *Music Beyond Headlines*, coordinating a team of 10+ photographers and writers across Australia to produce industry-standard content
- Contributing music photographer to publications and venues including Roundhouse UNSW, FBi Radio, AAA-Backstage
- Portrait and fashion photography published in magazines including Picton Magazine, Sheeba Magazine, Leiden
- 1 of 11 chosen from over 1300 applicants for a 6-month photography mentorship with Canon Australia in their inaugural Red Straps youth mentoring program in 2019

headspace Australia May 2021 - Jul. 2023

Youth National Reference Group Member

- Selected to advise on national public engagement, media and brand strategy and development, governance, and risk and assurance for the National Youth Mental Health Foundation, established by the Australian Government
- Attended the International Association of Youth Mental Health (IAYMH) conference in Copenhagen, Denmark 2022. Awarded financial bursary from IAYMH to attend.
- Public advocacy media features on cultural identity and mental health in an *Australia-wide campaign*, invited speaker on *SBS Insight*, a current affairs TV program, and SBS news articles (*web*, radio, and TV)
- Drafted submissions to the Australian Government Senate inquiry on ADHD and the National Mental Health Commission
- Consultant on *Digital Safety in the Metaverse* with Meta and Project Rockit

Quantium Feb. 2023 - Apr. 2023

Graduate Data Analyst*, full-time*

- Data analyst in the data management team of global data science and AI company utilizing SQL and Python to maintain database and draw business insights from Woolworths Group data
- Resigned to focus on pursuing career as an academic economist and to undertake pre-doc Research Fellow role full-time

New South Wales Ageing and Disability Commission Jan. 2021 - May 2021

Project Officer Intern, *part-time*

- Internship placement within the Strategy and Communications team
- Projects: setting up SQL database infrastructure, data analytics and communication to create marketing and quantitative collateral for external stakeholders, develop project briefs for multicultural community engagement and promotion of the rights of older people and adults with disability

Toyota Finance Australia Jun. 2020 - Dec. 2020

Data Science Intern, *full-time*

- UNSW Co-op Scholarship sponsored industry placement within the Data Science and Risk Management team
- Projects: predictive modeling in R and PowerBI to monitor customer retention trends, designed and built a competitor pricing engine using webscraping in Python for KINTO car rental service

UNSW Founders Jul. 2019 - Mar. 2022

Program Coordinator*, part-time*

- Developed, designed, and delivered entrepreneurial programs to UNSW students, staff, and alumni
- Managed the Higher-Degree Research Program supporting graduate research students commercialize their research innovations (2022), and the New Wave Program for promoting female engagement in entrepreneurship and within the startup space (2019)
- Developed an effective marketing strategy to recruit female participation in the New Wave program, resulting in the largest cohort since program inception
- Facilitate and teach design thinking, rapid prototyping, and lean canvas workshops

Art Projects and Performances

Musikalischer Abend, Musikplattform ETH/UZH, Zürich May 2026

Piano duet with Damian Camenisch

- Antonín Dvořák, Slavonic Dances, Op. 46, No. 1: Presto, No. 8: Presto

Musikalischer Abend, Musikplattform ETH/UZH, Zürich Nov. 2025

Piano duet with Damian Camenisch

- Johannes Brahms, Sixteen Waltzes, Op. 39, No. 1, 2, 3, 5, 7, 13, 14 & 15

Visible Artist's Noticeboard May - Jul. 2023

Mixed-media installation, exhibited at Bankstown Arts Centre

- *Video Feature*
- Commissioned for visible Australia's Western Sydney project, a creative collaboration between artists and young Australians experiencing mental health challenges to share their story as visual advocacy

In the box 2023

1:30 video, exhibited at Customs House Sydney

- Created for the Diversified x Essem Projects x UNSW Sydney project, a collaboration between inclusive design research and pluriversal community-led participatory exploration into the impact of public space media and digital inclusion for neurodivergent communities

Genderbility 2023

Community engagement zine project

- Lived-experience informed community zine project about neurodiversity and gender, collating qualitative research findings conducted through the University of Sydney Brain and Mind Centre in conjunction with headspace Camperdown
- Recipient of the Future Me Fund from Wear it Purple Australia 2023

Awards and Extracurriculars

- Board Director of World Meditation Day Association (2025 -)
- Winner of the Australian Financial Review/Gradconnection Top100 Future Leaders Award for the AECOM Mechanical and Electrical Engineering Award (2020)
- Board Director of Arc@UNSW and Chair of Nominations and Remunerations Subcommittee, the not-for-profit overarching organization for student experience and support services at UNSW (2019 - 2021)
- Undergraduate representative on the Faculty of Science Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion working group (2019 - 2022)
- Student representative on the UNSW Centre for Ideas advisory committee (2020 - 2022)
- Youth advisory group member for headspace Camperdown (2019 - 2023)
- Football Coach of the Randwick City Football Club's not-for-profit Purple Hearts all-abilities squads (2019 - 2020)
- Women's Premier League (WPL) football player, Australian Capital Territory (2015 - 2017 seasons)

Skills

Programming Languages:

Python, Stata, R, SQL, C

Certifications:

Standard Mental Health First Aid Certificate Australia (issued 2019)